Rotational Symmetry

Exam code: 0607

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Rotational symmetry

What is the order of rotational symmetry?

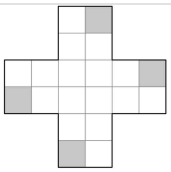
- **Rotational symmetry** refers to the number of times a shape looks the same as it is **rotated 360°** about its **centre**
- This number is called the **order** of **rotational symmetry**
- Tracing paper can help work out the order of rotational symmetry
  - Draw an arrow on the tracing paper so you can easily tell when you have turned it through 360°

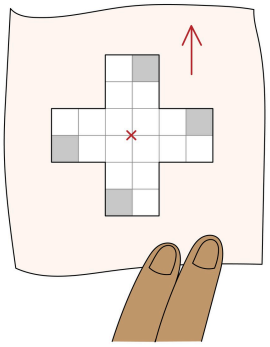
Help me understand

Stuck on something?

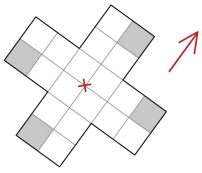
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

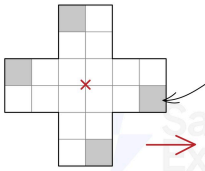




You can use tracing paper to help. Use an arrow so you know when you're back to the start



... as you turn the tracing paper count how many times the shape looks the same as the original



Be careful here. This shaded square is not quite the same as the original

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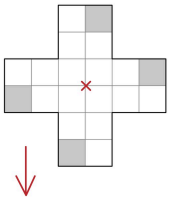
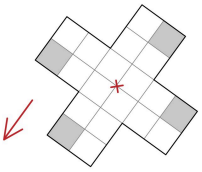
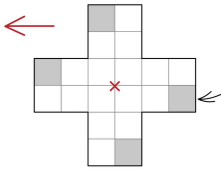


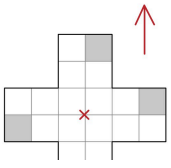
This is the same as the original (so "1" so "far")



Keep turning



Not quite – always be careful to check the original shape



"2"
Back to the original position, arrow facing upwards. This counts

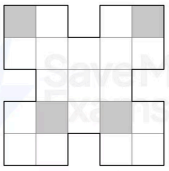
Examiner Tips and Tricks

Remember to use the trick above; using an upwards arrow on the tracing paper to show the starting orientation of the shape.

to the start

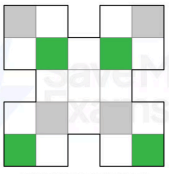
Worked Example

For the shape below, shade exactly 4 more squares so that the shape has rotational symmetry of order 4.



Answer:

The shape below appears the same 4 times if rotated through 360 degrees



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